profile operations, such as Lashkar's successful attacks against the Red Fort and Srinagar airport, further boosted recruitment and fundraising.[87]

The group operated recruiting offices on university campuses, and often dispatched fighters to these locations to convince students either to join directly or to attend the annual Ijtema in Muridke after which many were inspired to sign up. Indian savagery was a common recruitment motif. One member told the author that Lashkar militants who had been fighting in the Kashmir Valley came to his college and described the 'butchery by the Indians.'[88] A number of Lashkar cadres captured by the Indian security forces said they were told during the recruitment process about the demolition of mosques in India.[89] Another common recruitment motif was the celebration of martyrdom.

Lashkar representatives gathered people in town centers and sports fields via loudspeaker to say prayers for its martyrs. During these public ceremonies Lashkar lauded the fallen mujahid's family and sometimes his entire village. The martyr's testament, which often exhorted others to join the cause, was then read. All of this inevitably prompted other volunteers to come forward.[90] Local officials from the group also visited martyrs' homes to congratulate the family, distribute sweets to celebrate the death and use the occasion to solicit new recruits.[91] In addition to these special occasions, Lashkar displayed banners and used graffiti as persistent reminders of the glory of jihad. Common slogans included: 'Neither cricket stars nor movie stars, but Islamic mujahideen,' 'Prolong jihad with your lives and property in the name of God,' and 'Break the necks and joints of non-Muslims.' The group's flag was—and remains—conspicuously graffiti'd on many walls throughout Pakistan.[92]

Money and identity mattered too. For many youths, especially those with few employment opportunities, the chance to join a respected outfit like Lashkar and fight the hated Indians to liberate Kashmir offered a means of boosting their self-esteem and identity. Through its dawa, social services and jihadi exploits Lashkar gained a positive reputation, making it an even more attractive jihadi group to join. According to an International Crisis Group report, in the Lashkar stronghold of Gondlanwala the group became so influential that villagers would accept its arbitration in local and familial disputes. The village came to be called Pind Shaheedan, meaning